

Nicolas Wajs | Senior Services Project Manager

Paris, France

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Client delivery leader with 24 years running complex, regulated financial-software implementation and services engagements for banks, asset managers, and investment institutions across Europe. Track record of owning schedules, budgets (100K–2M project sizes, \$500K–3M deal cycles), scope, risk, and change management end to end, chairing steering committees with client sponsors and CIOs, and growing client accounts through trusted delivery. Native French, fluent professional English – comfortable leading bilingual, cross-functional teams across matrix organizations. New to the P&C insurance domain specifically, but 24 years inside regulated, complex, data-intensive financial software brings the same discipline of contractual delivery commitments, client governance, and risk management this role demands.

Core Competencies

- **Programme & Project Delivery:** End-to-end ownership of schedules, budgets, scope, deliverables, and change requests across implementation and upgrade programmes (100K–2M), from scoping/estimating through go-live and steady-state support
- **Client Governance & Steering Committees:** Chaired project reviews and Steering Committees with banking/asset-management clients; weekly CTO-level status reporting; sponsor and CIO-level relationship ownership
- **Risk, Issue & Change Management:** Identified, assessed, and managed project risks, issues, dependencies, and change requests across regulated production environments (ISO 27001, SOC 2 compliance delivery)
- **Team Leadership & Staffing:** Led, motivated, and staffed project teams from 10 to 25+ consultants (internal and offshore, Europe and Asia); mentored 45+ consultants; hands-on delivery when the engagement requires it
- **Client Service Growth:** Identified and developed expansion opportunities within existing accounts – sales-qualified opportunities up 65% at Finastra, upsell/renewal deals \$500K–\$3M, new accounts opened at Opensee (Kepler Cheuvreux, Taula Capital)
- **Languages:** French (native), English (fluent, spoken and written professionally), German (intermediate)
- **Tools:** Jira, Power BI, Tableau, Excel/PowerPoint/Outlook reporting deliverables

Professional Experience

- **Freelance, Data/AI & Financial Services** **Paris, France**
Client Delivery Lead *Jul 2025-Present*
 - Led delivery of a credit-structuring and securitization data platform through to production for a major European investment bank, coordinating cross-team delivery and ensuring a clean transition of live trading operations at go-live
 - Delivered a broker-voting web application for a French asset manager end to end – scoping through production go-live – in under two months, using an AI-assisted delivery approach
 - Advised institutional clients via expert-network engagements (Guidepoint, AlphaSights, Third Bridge) on treasury and capital-markets software; runs each engagement as a self-directed delivery unit – scoping, contracting, and client invoicing – the same accountability structure this role requires
- **Opensee** **Paris, France**
Product Manager – SaaS & Customer Success *Oct 2022-Apr 2025*
 - Owned the client relationship for a leading global asset manager end to end: led the first SaaS production go-live, exceeding contractual quality targets (over 99% vs 95% committed) through the first 6 months, with weekly KPI reporting to the client's CTO
 - Delivered ISO 27001 and SOC 2 compliance requirements for the platform's first regulated deployment, and built the first data-quality reporting suite and anomaly-escalation process with the client's operations teams, administering a shared Jira instance on the client's behalf
 - Grew the account footprint (Kepler Cheuvreux, Taula Capital) and delivered technical workshops reaching 100+ business and IT users, accelerating time-to-value and handover to customer success

- **Finastra** **Customer Experience**
Principal Product Advisor – EMEA & Americas *Sep 2017-Oct 2022*
 - Led discovery, solution design, and client workshops for 30+ large financial institutions across five countries (NYC, Brussels, Amsterdam, Paris, Verona), increasing sales-qualified opportunities by 65%
 - Coordinated RFP responses across competitive bids, contributing to upsell/renewal deal sizes of \$500K–\$3M; supervised presales engagements across 12 consultants, including French clients' regulatory continuity programmes during COVID
- **Misys** **Customer Services**
Lead Account Manager – Continental Europe *Aug 2013-Jun 2017*
 - Technical account and service management for 15+ buy-side and sell-side institutions (hedge funds, asset managers, investment banks), including \$100K+ premium support engagements spanning trade processing, risk management, and performance-attribution systems
 - Mentored 30 consultants across Europe and 15 across Asia (Beijing, Manila), including 5 weeks of on-site training and certification support
- **Sophis SAS** **Professional Services**
Consulting Project Manager – Continental Europe *Jul 2011-Jul 2013*
 - Delivered 7 implementation and upgrade programmes across Europe (Portfolio Management, Front-to-Back, Risk Management, Order Management, Compliance), budgets ranging 100K–2M, chairing Steering Committees with client sponsors and leading Statements of Work / RFQ/RFP/RFI quotations
 - Coordinated 25+ consultants across IT, toolkit development, and Front/Middle/Back Office workstreams
- **Thomson Reuters / Reuters** **Paris**
Product & Solution Manager; Product Quality & 3rd-Level Support Lead *2002-2011*
 - Scoped and delivered 30–60 software updates annually for Reuters Trader/EIKON across 4+ business verticals, coordinating development, QA, and 3rd-level support (2007–2011)
 - Managed a team of 10+ consultants and mentored 20+ consultants based in Bangkok; led functional QA coordinating 80+ FTEs on financial-model and analytics library validation (2002–2007)

Education

- **Ecole Polytechnique (X-EXED)** **Paris, France**
Certificate, AI for Business *2025-2026*
 Artificial Intelligence and Data Management.
- **Institut de Haute Finance (IHF 41)** **Paris, France**
Executive Master's, Corporate Finance & Capital Markets *2010-2012*
- **ENSIIE (formerly IIE-CNAM)** **France**
MSc, Data Management & Financial Modeling *1999-2002*

Certifications

- **Professional Risk Manager (PRM)** – PRMIA, 2019.
- **Product & AI** (2025): Aha! PM Professional; Dataiku GenAI Practitioner & Core Designer; LangChain/RAG & CrewAI (DeepLearning.AI).

Languages

- French (native), English (fluent, spoken and written professionally), German (intermediate).

References

- Available upon request.